almost all channels today transmit using stereo audio (two channels of audio), some channels have switched over to surround sound transmissions (three or more channels of audio, to give a more realistic perception of sound).

With the origin of the idea in some science fiction works of the 1870s, television, then known as the telephonoscope was deemed inevitable with the rapid development in the ability to generate and transmit images. The earliest ancestor to the television can be seen in the telephonoscope built by Paul Gottlieb Nipkow in 1884. This design used a pendulum with holes in it, swinging in front of selenium plates that were sensitive to light. Producing extremely poor quality images by today's standards (it would appear to be a series of black and white dots of varying size), these images still could not be displayed on screens until the technology became available in 1907.

The true father of modern television is John Logie Baird, a Scottish inventor who improved the device designed by Nipkow to transmit outline images in 1925, and later full images in 1926. He used a scanning device which could scan 30 vertical lines, just about enough to capture a discernible human face. He also pioneered the concept of video recording, modulating the video signals down to the audio frequency range and storing them on small disks available at that time. These disks were, in the early 1990s, converted back into viewable images, using advances in digital signal processing.

The telephonoscope built by Paul Gottlieb Nipkow in 1884 made way for the television as we know it today

Soon methods were devised to convert the electronic video signals into radio waves, and to transmit, receive and display them like audio signals. By the 1960s, television had spread to almost all parts of the globe and by the 1990s almost every country had its own broadcasting stations. Certain other notable developments in television technology were the advent of satellite broadcasting, the birth of digital and later high definition television.

Wireless broadcasting of television signals can be broadly classified into two categories.